

Do not make the fatal mistake of looking at five businesses at once. Learn all you can about the business that jumps out for whatever reason and fixate solely on it. Once you're at the finish line with your analysis, only then look at the broader circle of competence.

To conclude, I'd like to share a few final thoughts. The best way to learn is to teach, and writing this book has served as a tremendous learning experience for me. I likely wouldn't have written it if the people at John Wiley & Sons hadn't encouraged me. I'm grateful for the opportunity and the experience.

This entire book focuses purely on ways to maximize your wealth. My dear father passed away in 1997. He always said that we come to this world naked and we leave the world naked. No one has succeeded in taking even a pin with them. He said that we need to fill in the blanks between birth and death. To that, I like to add that a life focused purely on the maximization of wealth or creature comforts for self and family is a sub-optimal approach to living.

Abraham George hails from Kerala in India, and I'm proud to call him a friend. He came to the United States a few decades ago and did very well as an entrepreneur—ending up with several million dollars when he sold his business a few years ago. He's chosen to plow most of it back through the George Foundation (www.tgfworld.org), and they have done some remarkable projects in India, helping the very poorest of the poor. Recently, an impoverished person who had been helped by his foundation asked him, "Why do you help me?" George brushed off the question with a non-answer saying, "I like you. That's why." The man persisted and asked him, "Why do you help all of us?" George could see that the man wanted a real answer. He gave him a very real answer. He said, "Helping you makes me happy." I suspect that the happiness George derives from these endeavors is vastly more satisfying than having a fleet of Gulfstreams or palatial homes around the planet. I hope you'll seek out the same happiness that Abraham George and countless others have found.

Kahlil Gibran had some amazing perspectives on life to share in his little book, *The Prophet*.¹ There are no wasted words or pages in that beautiful book. It is indeed very hard to live up to Gibran's high standards, but